
Back to School 2026 Campaign Brief

"Ready for the New Term" | Campaign Code: JD-BTS-26001

Author: Marketing Director
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1. Campaign Overview

The Back to School campaign is the second most important trading period of the year after Christmas, generating approximately GBP 480 million in revenue across the six-week campaign window from 1 August to 12 September 2026. This represents approximately 9% of full-year revenue concentrated into 11% of the year.

The campaign objective is to achieve revenue of GBP 480 million with a footfall uplift of 8% versus the prior year. The target average order value is GBP 78.00. The target customer is parents of children aged 4 to 16, with a secondary audience of university students aged 18 to 21.

Campaign Revenue Target: GBP 480 million

Footfall Uplift: +8% vs prior year

Target Average Order Value: GBP 78.00

Campaign Period: 1 Aug to 12 Sep 2026

2. Hero Products

Ten hero products are designated for the campaign, with dedicated marketing support, enhanced stock allocation, and prominent in-store positioning.

Nike Air Force 1 Low (GBP 100 RRP). Target volume of 45,000 pairs. The single most important SKU for the campaign. The white colourway is a school uniform staple across the UK and consistently sells through within the first three weeks of August.

Adidas Gazelle (GBP 85 RRP). Target volume of 38,000 pairs. Resurgence in younger demographics driven by terrace fashion trends.

Nike Dunk Low (GBP 105 RRP). Target volume of 32,000 pairs. Popular with secondary school age children.

Converse Chuck Taylor All Star (GBP 60 RRP). Target volume of 28,000 pairs. Entry price point for iconic footwear.

Vans Old Skool (GBP 65 RRP). Target volume of 22,000 pairs. Consistent performer across all age groups.

Nike Tech Fleece Full Zip Hoodie (GBP 120 RRP). Target volume of 18,000 units.

Adidas Originals 3-Stripes Tracksuit (GBP 95 RRP). Target volume of 15,000 units.

The North Face Nuptse Jacket (GBP 265 RRP). Target volume of 8,000 units. Early season outerwear.

Under Armour Backpack (GBP 45 RRP). Target volume of 25,000 units.

Nike Elite Socks 3-Pack (GBP 18 RRP). Target volume of 40,000 packs. High-volume add-on with strong margin.

3. Promotional Mechanics

Three core promotional mechanics will operate during the campaign period.

20% off full-price footwear runs from 15 August to 31 August. The expected margin impact on promoted footwear is a reduction of 5 to 6 percentage points versus full-price margin. The discount is funded jointly by JD and the relevant brands.

3 for 2 on accessories runs for the full campaign period from 1 August to 12 September. This mechanic applies to socks, caps, bags, and shoe care products. Accessories margins of 51% to 55% mean that a 3 for 2 promotion still delivers positive gross margin.

10% student discount via Student Beans runs for the full campaign period. This is a permanent discount mechanic available year-round but is heavily promoted during Back to University in September.

4. Media and Marketing Spend

The total media budget for the Back to School campaign is GBP 3.8 million.

Google Ads accounts for GBP 1.2 million (32% of budget) with a target return on ad spend of 4.2 times. Meta, including Facebook and Instagram, accounts for GBP 1.0 million (26%) with a target ROAS of 5.0 times. TikTok accounts for GBP 800,000 (21%) with a target ROAS of 6.5 times. Television advertising accounts for GBP 500,000 (13%). Influencer partnerships account for GBP 300,000 (8%) with ten family and lifestyle influencers reaching a combined 3 million followers.

5. Stock Requirements

Total stock allocation for the campaign is 1.8 million units. Hero SKU stock is allocated to all 472 stores plus the online fulfilment centre. Flagstaff stores receive 100% of the hero SKU range, A tier stores receive 80%, B tier stores 60%, and C tier stores 40%.

A buffer of 15% above forecast demand is held at the distribution centres for hero SKUs only. All campaign stock must be delivered to the DCs by 25 July to allow for allocation and distribution before the 1 August launch.

6. In-Store Execution and Staffing

All 472 stores will have dedicated Back to School window schemes and in-store point of sale materials. The largest 200 stores will also have dedicated Back to School zones with enhanced fixtures and digital screens.

Early access for JD Status members runs from 8 August to 14 August, one week before the general promotion starts. An additional 250 temporary colleagues will be recruited for the distribution centres and 120 additional in-store colleagues deployed across the 100 highest-traffic stores for peak Saturdays. The total additional labour cost is estimated at GBP 500,000.

7. Contingency Plan

A 10% buffer stock holding is maintained for the top 20 SKUs. An overnight airfreight option is pre-approved for the top 5 SKUs with a GBP 40,000 budget. A dual-carrier agreement is in place with both DPD and UPS. If website traffic exceeds 5 times normal volume, the site auto-scales with non-essential features temporarily disabled to prioritise checkout performance.

8. Success Metrics and KPIs

Campaign revenue target of GBP 480 million, equivalent to 9% of full-year revenue across 6 weeks.

Like-for-like sales growth of 5% versus the prior year Back to School campaign.

Average order value of GBP 78.00, up from GBP 75.00 in the prior year.

Footfall uplift of 8% versus the prior year across the store estate.

Conversion rate of 22% in stores and 5.2% online.

Return on ad spend of 5.0 times across all media channels blended.

JD Status member acquisition of 40,000 new paying members.

Customer satisfaction score of 4.2 out of 5 or higher.

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